

Foundation Budget

Residential Foundation Example | Corning area, California | 2026-09-15 | USD

DE-IDENTIFIED HISTORICAL EXAMPLE - NOT CURRENT PRICING

Item	Estimate
Net concrete quantity	35.33 yd3 (27.01 m3)
Including waste (+8%)	38.15 yd3 (29.17 m3)
Budgeted concrete order	40.00 yd3 (30.58 m3)
Ready-mix concrete	40 yd3 x USD 210.00/yd3 = USD 8,400.00
Burdened labor	448 h x USD 65.00/h = USD 29,120.00
Direct construction cost	USD 61,420.00
Complete foundation budget	USD 79,108.96
Low / high scenarios	USD 55,204.60 - USD 117,517.35

Included scope

Lower-level/garage slab, landing, strip footings, retaining wall/returns, 10 pads, HVAC pad; ordinary earthwork, reinforcing/formwork, pumping, labor, base, drainage/waterproofing and cleanup.

Drawing basis

De-identified 18-sheet residential example, mainly pages 4-8 and 12-13. Unverified wall heights/details remain labeled assumptions; customer drawings are not included.

De-identified historical example. Rates are unquoted estimating allowances from the original estimate, not current prices or fixed bids.

Sales/use tax has not been added. Confirm local taxes and what supplier quotes include.

Concrete Quantities

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Item	Basis / formula / source	Net yd3
Lower-level and garage slab	$16 \times 36 + 8 \times 26.5 = 788 \text{ sq ft.}$ $788 * 4 / 12 / 27$ [Derived] Plans, pages 5-8	9.73
Landing	44 sq ft; thickness assumed 4 in. $8 * 5.5 * 4 / 12 / 27$ [Allowance] Foundation plan, page 8	0.54
HVAC pad	Assume 4 ft square x 4 in. $4 * 4 * 4 / 12 / 27$ [Allowance] Page 8 pad symbol; size unconfirmed	0.20
Strip footing net addition	178.5 ft grouped at 20/24/36 in heights; deduct 4 in slab. $1 * (122.5 * (20 - 4) / 12 + 36 * (24 - 4) / 12 + 20 * (36 - 4) / 12) / 27$ [Allowance] Pages 8/12; grouped lengths assumed	10.25
Retaining wall and footing	Assume 9 ft wall; footing 24 in wide x 12 in thick. $28 * (8 / 12 * 9 + 2 * 1) / 27$ [Allowance] Pages 8/13; 9 ft is a maximum detail height, not measured	8.30
Returns, footings and keys	12 ft total, 4.5 ft average wall height; provisional footing/key. $12 * (8 / 12 * 4.5 + 5.333333 * 1 + 1 * 2.5) / 27$ [Allowance] Page 13 Detail 29; upper schedule values used for allowance	4.81
Pad net additions	2 PAD36, 2 PAD30, 4 PAD24, 2 PAD18; deduct strip overlaps. 1 [Allowance] Page 8; gross 1.89 yd3, net allowance 1 yd3	1.00
Curbs, steps and local details	Local level-change allowance. 0.5 [Allowance] Pages 8/12; confirm during setting-out	0.50
Net concrete quantity		35.33
Budgeted concrete order	8% waste	40.00

Assumptions and unresolved dimensions

1. The 9 ft main wall is assumed, not a confirmed actual height. Each extra foot adds about 0.69 yd3 of wall concrete.
2. Returns assume 4.5 ft average height, 5 ft 4 in x 12 in footings and 12 in x 30 in in keys; these are takeoff allowances, not design.
3. Verify strip height groups and overlaps. Pad gross volume is 1.89 yd3; provisional net addition is 1 yd3.
4. General slab notes show #3 at 24 in; retaining details show #4 at 24 in. Reconcile architectural block-wall notes with cast-in-place details.

Materials, Labor & Total Cost

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Item	Low	Base	High
Ready-mix concrete	6,840.00	8,400.00	10,560.00
Burdened labor	19,800.00	29,120.00	42,000.00
Rebar and embeds	2,500.00	3,500.00	4,500.00
Forms/bracing materials and rental	3,000.00	4,500.00	6,000.00
Aggregate, sand, vapor barrier	1,400.00	2,100.00	3,000.00
Drainage/waterproofing materials	1,200.00	1,800.00	3,000.00
Pump/mobilization	2,200.00	3,000.00	4,200.00
Excavation/backfill/compaction/hauling	6,000.00	8,000.00	14,000.00
Consumables/curing/cleanup	700.00	1,000.00	1,600.00
Direct construction cost	43,640.00	61,420.00	88,860.00
Contractor overhead / profit (10% / 12% / 15%)	4,364.00	7,370.40	13,329.00
Contingency (15% / 15% / 15%)	7,200.60	10,318.56	15,328.35
Complete foundation budget	55,204.60	79,108.96	117,517.35

Amounts are rounded to cents for display; calculations use unrounded values. Contingency applies to direct cost plus overhead/profit. Taxes are not added by the calculator; see the project tax note.

Sales/use tax has not been added. Confirm local taxes and what supplier quotes include.

Rates and allowance basis

Low/base/high USD 190/210/240 per yd3, provisionally including standard delivery. Base order override of 40 yd3 preserves the original conservative allowance.

Rebar and embeds: Approx. 0.8-1.2 metric tonnes plus embeds; verify bar schedule.

Forms/bracing materials and rental: Retaining-wall and footing forms; labor separate.

Aggregate, sand, vapor barrier: Provisional 12 yd3 aggregate, 6 yd3 sand and vapor barrier; additional drainage aggregate.

Drainage/waterproofing materials: Perforated pipe, filter fabric and waterproof/protection materials.

Pump/mobilization: 2-3 visits, including operators.

Excavation/backfill/compaction/hauling: Equipment subcontract includes operators/ordinary disposal; earthwork unmeasured.

Consumables/curing/cleanup: Ordinary consumables, small equipment and cleanup.

Labor & Verification

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Item	Labor-hours	Base labor cost
Layout/base coordination	48	3,120.00
Forms/bracing	200	13,000.00
Rebar/embeds	64	4,160.00
Place/finish	64	4,160.00
Strip/cure/clean	48	3,120.00
Waterproof/drainage installation	24	1,560.00
Burdened labor	448	29,120.00

Labor includes wages and employer burden. Excavation and pump subcontract allowances include their operators; do not count them again here. Overall overhead/profit is separate. Worker-days use 8 hours; inspections and curing extend calendar duration.

Low: 360 h x USD 55.00/h; High: 560 h x USD 75.00/h.

Verify before quoting / ordering

1. Confirm wall heights, return elevations, detail mapping, final concrete strength and reinforcement.
2. Confirm bearing soil, haul distance, equipment/pump access, drainage outlets and pour quantities.

Scope limits

1. Upper timber floors/decks/stairs, full driveway, undefined patios/off-plan walls, underground services, design/permits and special inspections excluded.
2. Piles, rock, special dewatering/shoring and contaminated soil are outside ordinary earthwork allowances.